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Write. Write. Write.

Your bones fuse into place.

It feels slight at first, like a shift in the air.

Then you realise, with much effort, that even the strongest of movements will not wrench you from your seat.

Moving hurts.

Everything hurts, to be fair.

Note the neck you've broken doing who-knows-what, hanging limp only a few seconds before, now still with swan-like grace and trained on whatever mess lies below—

Slow. Steady. Slow.

There is a window. There *was* a window at least, and you often stared through the glass; too high for comfort, but too low for grandeur. Just right for prison.

From what you remember (although memories are slippery, unreliable fish), the sky was grey. Pale grey, like a cast of fog— and in your semi-conscious state, you remember wondering whether there was life out there. Beyond prison.

If there was life, you thought, then perhaps it would disappear upon your leaving— then all would be for naught, you would hang your head in despair, and—

Calm. Look. Stay.

There is/was also a clock.

The past tense haunts you.

“Is” and “was” are wrung out of meaning, there ████ an analog clock on the table, neon red numbers, five and a half hours left; it tells rather than shows.

Breaths grow steady and trail after one another— slow, slow, slower, matching the cadence of your heartbeat. There is a clock on the table that you cannot read as your bones continue to fuse, pentadactyl bits ossifying around the pen you hold

Or may have held, since you are clamping it now; so hard, so desperately, that the wood splinters and sends pain down the length of what has now become a human-thing meld.

Bone growth hurts, by the way. You feel as if you haven't made yourself clear—

Now. Then. Again.

People sit somewhere. Perhaps around, but that is neither here nor there.

Pain and swelling are standard physiological responses to stress. Abnormality.

People, so you call them, creep in shadow at the edges of your vision, lurking right behind what comforts you most; what you do not expect or realise, just the littlest of slips— oh joy, a carton you've forgotten to close— and all the eggs have spilled around, here *and* there, and suddenly slowness does not comfort you as much as leaning into the quick breaths and the way your sternum presses against skin, begging to break through—

So. Sew. Sow.

There are walls. Female pigs live horrible lives.

Oh. What?

The handle from which your mind slips is so tangible you could lick it.

Bowed like so, visibility is limited, but you swear you can see the walls. Them and no floor.

And there are eyes in the walls, likely an extension of the people, and the clock, and the window. And what they have in common, of course, is bone. Yes, bone.

It all comes back to bone, because your bones are fusing into place and the bones of this place are old, but not old enough to lose their psychopathic spark;

They love watching you stuck in place, gritting your teeth in dole, face betraying only a fraction of your anguish because *dog* help you, breathing won't cut it anymore, and they love you in some horrid motherly way—

Happy Mother's Day.

I Hate Endosymbiotic Theory

Biology swims in my head.

It is a parasitic fish or

More accurately, a self-imposing prokaryote that invaded my space

And opened itself up to digestion

But refused to finish the deed and die.

I do not condone mutualisation of this sort.

I do not condone any mutualisation with science,

For even though I am science, and

Nobody can ever separate themselves from their science,

I've grown tired of it.

Whenever my nuclear membranes dissolve,

Euchromatin condensing to heterochromatin—

Each time the centripetal furrows form and I feel a

Minuscule bit of myself splitting in two—

My pain seems to divide as well and

Given the near-infinite luck of being, will not apoptose.

To be a biology student.

Or not to be.

I would much rather disappear into the ground and forfeit all my brainpower,

So saturated with hippocampal pathways that my skull tips like a dented bottle.

I would rather exchange knowledge for simple saprotrophic joy;

Preferably tromping around brainless, and preferably

With no wish to see myself dissected.

I Hate Population Ecology

The bugs have gone missing.
The bugs have dropped off and become one with the soil,
The saprotrophs, the carbon cycle
As all returns to what it once was, only
Different in name

I am alive.
And I am ignorant of this—
But the bugs are missing, which is a fact
We have lost five percent of them
To thin air, sheer cloud;
“Endangered” spelled out over sheets of BT corn pollen

I am alive.
If four hundred million *humans* dropped off the face of the Earth,
I imagine we’d care a whole lot more
But the bugs have gone missing
And silently, for want of revenge, they have died

I Hate Apical Meristems

This and ripe, haloed birch-tips;
Winter layers that part from bulk, flitting into the sun.
This, and heads raise
As grass follows to meet them
Until there is nothing to be met

I Hate the Human Body

Please do not treat me.

Extract my glomeruli and pass blood through them. Large plasma proteins should be barred
at the basement membrane. If this works properly, plant a tree.

Now, take each component of muscle and organise them into individual groups, individual
muscles— then break them down into fascicles, fibres, myofibrils, and sarcomeres.

Observe how saltatory conduction is soon to cease.

Examine the slow, irregular two-step noise of my heartbeat; one from the atrioventricular valve and another from the aortic. Is the sinoatrial node working as it should?
Is the myocardium in order?

Females produce all their eggs as foetuses. There they sit in arrested development until puberty, undergoing meiosis I and II according to milestones.
Males produce their sperm consistently and often.

Now, poke at my organs and determine which of the three sexes I might be.
If I am none, plant a tree.

My plasma cells have degraded. My intercostals have wasted away. Good livers will convert glycogen to glucose when the need is greatest. Please plant a tree.